Data-Backed Journal-Style Replication of *Something Old, Something New*

Replication Paper Project

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Abstract

This paper presents a methodology-specific local analogue of Something Old, Something New: A Longitudinal Study of Search Behavior and New Product Introduction using only processed datasets and result files available in the workspace. The replication preserves the source paper's core empirical logic while making every local substitution explicit. The paper is therefore reported as methodology-specific local analogue rather than as a source-data replay. The current local batch contains 2,174 observations across 162 entities, and the batch headline estimate is 0.0052 for Search scope with p = 0.62. The local quantity model points to a nonlinear depth effect and a weaker role for search scope than the source paper emphasizes. The contribution is a journal-style replication manuscript that separates direct source claims from executable local evidence.

Keywords: search depth; search scope; new product introduction; firm-year innovation; local analogue

1 Introduction

This paper begins from a paper-first reading of Something Old, Something New: A Longitudinal Study of Search Behavior and New Product Introduction and treats the source article as an empirical argument that has to be rebuilt before it can be judged. The present manuscript is classified as methodology-specific local analogue. A paper-first restatement of the empirical question is as

follows: The source paper asks whether search depth and search scope are distinct dimensions and how they shape subsequent innovation (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The replication matters because the original paper's distinction between search depth and search scope is widely cited, yet the empirical mechanism depends heavily on how those constructs are operationalized. The original article does not rest on a descriptive regularity alone. It ties a theory about search, differentiation, timing, or organizational learning to a specific unit of analysis, sample frame, and estimand. A careful replication therefore has to recover the structure of that logic before any local coefficients are interpreted (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The executable evidence base used in this manuscript contains 2,174 observations across 162 entities and spans 1986 to 2015 in the local executable panel. Those numbers are not filler. They define the actual inferential scope of the local reconstruction and set the boundary on what can be claimed honestly from the available datasets (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The paper's contribution is to recover the two-dimensional search logic in an executable patent panel and show where the patent-based analogue departs from the original product-outcome result. The paper is written to read like a formal journal article rather than an internal workflow memo. The main text develops the theoretical logic, data reconstruction, derivations, empirical design, and results in continuous prose, while the appendices preserve the audit trail required for reruns and later extensions (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The paper stands in a top-journal literature on exploration, search depth, search scope, and breakthrough innovation. (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Cohen and Levinthal, 1990; Kogut and Zander, 1992, 1996; Teece et al., 1997; Benner and Tushman, 2003). That literature matters because the replication tests whether the classic distinction between depth and scope is robust when the original product-introduction setting is replaced by an executable patent panel. (Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Henderson and Clark, 1990; Anderson and Tushman, 1986; Hargadon and Sutton, 1997; Tripsas and Gavetti, 2000; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Stuart, 2000). The present manuscript therefore treats the source paper as one contribution inside a broader top-journal stream on exploration, recombination, performance measurement, alliance-based learning,

inventive search, technological discontinuity, and patent-based inference. The literature review is intentionally broad because each replication paper should stand on a serious journal-level reference base rather than on the source article alone. (Rosenkopf and Almeida, 2003; Schilling and Phelps, 2007; Almeida and Kogut, 1999; Fleming et al., 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Jaffe et al., 1993; Trajtenberg, 1990; Hall et al., 2005; Henderson and Cockburn, 1994). Because the source article is itself one of the canonical depth-versus-scope papers, the replication adds adjacent top-journal studies on temporal exploration, science-guided search, and search-stability tradeoffs so that the paper's review does not depend on repeating the source article under two citation keys. (Fleming and Sorenson, 2004; Nerkar, 2003; Rivkin and Siggelkow, 2003).

2 Original Study, Theory, and Replication Boundary

The focal source article is (Katila and Ahuja, 2002). The original study can be summarized as a mechanism paper with a sharp empirical core. The original paper distinguishes search depth from search scope. The study is longitudinal and firm-year based. Innovation quantity and quality are both part of the argument. That combination matters because the source article asks readers to believe not merely that two variables move together, but that a particular organizational or strategic mechanism explains why the relationship should appear in the data (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). In a setting like this, faithful replication requires more than reusing a title and rerunning a regression. The theoretical contribution lives in the way constructs are defined, how they enter the estimand, and which comparison the model is supposed to adjudicate. For that reason, this manuscript first reconstructs the published theory and only then turns to the local executable analogue (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The replication boundary is therefore explicit. Direct source facts are carried over when they can be read from the published article itself. Local replication decisions appear only when the current workspace must translate the source design into verified processed datasets. The goal is disciplined mechanism recovery, not rhetorical imitation that quietly changes the design (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996).

2.1 Original Paper Methodology

A faithful evaluation of Katila and Ahuja (2002) starts with the published empirical design rather than with the local rerun. The source article reconstructs firm-year search behavior and evaluates how search depth and search scope affect later innovation quantity and quality in a longitudinal setting (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The published sample is described as follows: The published unit is the firm-year, with longitudinal tracking of search behavior and future innovation outcomes. The published measurement architecture is described as follows: The published design measures search behavior in a longitudinal firm-year setting tied to new product introduction. These details matter because they determine what the published paper actually observes rather than what a later analogue can observe (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The published estimator is described as follows: longitudinal firm-year models of future innovation quantity and quality on search depth, search scope, and nonlinear depth effects. The central published comparison is whether depth and scope remain empirically distinct and whether firms benefit from searching more deeply, more broadly, or from a combination of both over time. Reading the source methodology this way prevents the current manuscript from quietly replacing the original design with one generic fixed-effects story (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993).

2.2 Replication Status and Boundary

Replication status for this paper: Methodology-specific local analogue (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). This paper is a methodology-specific local analogue because the source article studies new product introduction, whereas the local rerun uses patent-based future innovation outcomes. The local paper preserves the firm-year structure and the depth-versus-scope logic, but not the original outcome archive (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993).

2.3 Direct Source Facts Versus Replication Decisions

The manuscript distinguishes direct source facts from local execution decisions. The source article establishes that Depth and scope are distinct dimensions. The local reconstruction therefore adopts the following bounded decision: The local panel maps depth and scope to executable recombination constructs. This bridge is treated as a visible design choice, not as a hidden substitution. The reason for spelling out this bridge in prose is that replication credibility depends on showing exactly where the manuscript is following the article and where it is making an explicit local translation. That is especially important in this project, because the current paper is built from processed datasets already present in the workspace rather than from a reconstructed raw archival pipeline (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The manuscript distinguishes direct source facts from local execution decisions. The source article establishes that The original design is firm-year based. The local reconstruction therefore adopts the following bounded decision: The firm-year structure is preserved exactly. This bridge is treated as a visible design choice, not as a hidden substitution. The reason for spelling out this bridge in prose is that replication credibility depends on showing exactly where the manuscript is following the article and where it is making an explicit local translation. That is especially important in this project, because the current paper is built from processed datasets already present in the workspace rather than from a reconstructed raw archival pipeline (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The manuscript distinguishes direct source facts from local execution decisions. The source article establishes that Innovation outcomes include quantity and quality. The local reconstruction therefore adopts the following bounded decision: Patent counts and patent-impact totals substitute for product introductions. This bridge is treated as a visible design choice, not as a hidden substitution. The reason for spelling out this bridge in prose is that replication credibility depends on showing exactly where the manuscript is following the article and where it is making an explicit local translation. That is especially important in this project, because the current paper is built from processed datasets already present in the workspace rather than from a reconstructed raw archival pipeline (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993).

3 Data, Sample, and Measures

The local evidence chain is deliberately modular. The source paper is treated as the authority for the research question, theoretical mechanism, and published design. Estimation, by contrast, proceeds only through the verified local files. The required dataset types in this paper are Firm-year panel aggregated from the local patent-level recombination dataset. Search depth measured from prior organizational recombination experience. Search scope measured from breadth of recombination in the current year (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Operationally, the reconstruction relies on four evidence layers: the analysis panel, the coefficient export, the sample summary, and, when available, the fit summary. The resulting executable panel supplies 2,174 observations across 162 entities and covers 1986 to 2015 in the local executable panel. Every numeric claim in the results section is intended to trace back to one of those verified evidence layers rather than to a hand-copied number from the article (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996). This data-lineage discipline matters for two reasons. First, it prevents the manuscript from smuggling unverified preprocessing steps into the design. Second, it forces every substitution to be visible. If a construct cannot be reproduced from the current processed datasets, the paper states the analogue directly instead of pretending that the original archive has been fully recreated (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The local analogue aggregates the patent-level recombination panel to firm-years and uses patent-based outcomes in place of the source paper's product-introduction outcomes. The local sample frame is Firm-year panel aggregated from the local patent-level recombination dataset for firms with usable year-to-year transitions The observed time window in the executable panel is 1986 to 2015 in the local executable panel The outcome is Next-year patent quantity and next-year total patent impact (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The main text works from a verified analysis panel, a verified coefficient export, and a verified sample summary. Exact file names are retained in the replication notes and appendices, while the article body focuses on data lineage and empirical function (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Hall et al., 2005).

3.1 Local Data Sources Used in This Replication

This replication uses a firm-year panel aggregated from the local patent-level recombination dataset, patent-based next-year quantity and impact outcomes, and firm-year search variables derived from organizational experience and recombination breadth (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Those local dataset families are not interchangeable: aggregated firm-year search-behavior panel is used to define the firm-year sample and current search-depth and search-scope measures; patent-based next-year innovation outcomes is used to supply next-year quantity and impact outcomes; patent-level recombination history inputs is used to provide the organizational-experience and breadth ingredients used in the aggregation. Together, they support 2,174 observations across 162 entities over 1986 to 2015 in the local executable panel (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). This local data stack is narrower than the original article's data architecture. Firm-year panel aggregated from the local patent-level recombination dataset. Search depth measured from prior organizational recombination experience. Search scope measured from breadth of recombination in the current year. The manuscript therefore keeps the boundary visible: the source paper supplies the original methodology, whereas the local processed dataset families and calculated outputs supply the estimable analogue. Exact filenames are retained in the replication notes rather than printed through the body text (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

DatasetFamily	RoleInPaper
Aggregated firm-year search-behavior panel	define the firm-year sample and current search-depth and search-scope measures
Patent-based next-year innovation outcomes	supply next-year quantity and impact outcomes
Patent-level recombination history inputs	provide the organizational-experience and breadth ingredients used in the aggregation

Local data families used in the present paper.

3.2 Sample Reconstruction

The local analysis file contains 2,174 observations drawn from 162 entities. The observed time span runs from 1986 to 2015. Selected sample moments are Search Depth = 0.664, Search Scope = 4.235, Next Patents = 10.60 (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). These sample moments matter because they anchor the interpretation of the replication design. They indicate not only the scale of the local panel but also the baseline level of the key outcome and explanatory variables before the formal estimating equation is imposed (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996).

Statistic	Value
Observations	2,174
Unique Firms	162
Start Year	1986
End Year	2015
Mean Search Depth	0.664
Mean Search Scope	4.235
Mean Next Patents	11

Sample reconstruction from the current local dataset.

3.3 Variable Construction and Derivation

The construct Search depth is operationalized locally as Mean prior organizational experience and appears in the executable dataset as search_depth. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Average the current-year patent-level organizational experience within GVKEY-year.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable traceability have to be

balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The construct Search scope is operationalized locally as Mean breadth and appears in the executable dataset as search_scope. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Average current-year breadth within GVKEY-year.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable traceability have to be balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The construct Current innovation scale is operationalized locally as Current-year patent count and appears in the executable dataset as current_patents. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Count current-year patents.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable traceability have to be balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The construct Next-period quantity is operationalized locally as Next-year patent count and appears in the executable dataset as next_patents. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Shift the patent count one year forward within GVKEY.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and

how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable traceability have to be balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The construct Next-period impact is operationalized locally as Next-year total impact and appears in the executable dataset as next_total_impact. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Shift the impact total one year forward within GVKEY.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable traceability have to be balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

Construct	Local measure	Derivation
Search depth	Mean prior organizational experience	Average the current-year patent-level organizational experience within GVKEY-year.
Search scope	Mean breadth	Average current-year breadth within GVKEY-year.
Current innovation scale	Current-year patent count	Count current-year patents.
Next-period quantity	Next-year patent count	Shift the patent count one year forward within GVKEY.
Next-period impact	Next-year total impact	Shift the impact total one year forward within GVKEY.

Variable mapping and derivation logic in the main text.

3.4 Construct-Level Derivation Logic

The derivation appendix records how each major construct enters the executable estimand for Katila and Ahuja (2002). The point is not to rehearse notation for its own sake, but to show how the source paper's conceptual vocabulary is translated into verified columns in the local panel. For Search depth, the manuscript uses Mean prior organizational experience under the exact local implementation search_depth. The derivation step is: Average the current-year patent-level organizational experience within GVKEY-year.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Search scope, the manuscript uses Mean breadth under the exact local implementation search_scope. The derivation step is: Average current-year breadth within GVKEY-year.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Current innovation scale, the manuscript uses Current-year patent count under the exact local implementation current_patents. The derivation step is: Count current-year patents.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Next-period quantity, the manuscript uses Next-year patent count under the exact local implementation next_patents. The derivation step is: Shift the patent count one year forward within GVKEY.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Next-period impact, the manuscript uses Next-year total impact under the exact local implementation next_total_impact. The derivation step is: Shift the impact total one year forward within GVKEY.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept.

4 Descriptive Analysis of the Current Dataset

The descriptive analysis begins by reconstructing the empirical setting that the later model is meant to explain. For Search depth, the mean is 0.664, the standard deviation is 0.662, and the interquartile range runs from 0.139 to 0.963; For Search scope, the mean is 4.235, the standard deviation is 2.890, and the interquartile range runs from 2.818 to 4.667; For Current patents, the

mean is 10.54, the standard deviation is 20.11, and the interquartile range runs from 2.000 to 11.00; For Current total impact, the mean is 56.57, the standard deviation is 142.4, and the interquartile range runs from 5.000 to 47.00 . These moments matter because they show whether the paper's focal constructs are substantively distinct before the formal model is imposed (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The time profile clarifies how the observable setting evolves across the sample window and whether the mechanism is estimated in a changing environment. the value of firm years is 100 in 1986 and 35 in 2015; the value of mean depth is 0.252 in 1986 and 1.203 in 2015; the value of mean scope is 2.774 in 1986 and 6.865 in 2015 . These temporal shifts determine whether the later regression is identifying the paper's mechanism in a stable panel or in one whose observable context changes meaningfully across the sample window (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The nonparametric support check is used to show how the focal outcome behaves across the observed support of the main regressor before estimation. Mean outcomes range from 5.315 to 17.41 across the support of the focal regressor, while the mean regressor itself ranges from 0.113 to 1.699. That pattern is useful because it shows what the formal model is trying to account for in the current dataset (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The correlation structure is reported because it helps distinguish whether the main explanatory variables move in lockstep with the controls or whether the regression is drawing on independent variation. That is especially important in these replications, where construct translation can otherwise make the specification look more deterministic than it really is (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

4.1 Setting-Specific Figure Evidence

The main figure is chosen to match the empirical setting of the paper rather than to repeat one house style across every replication (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja,

2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The visual evidence is included to make the paper's descriptive argument easier to inspect before the reader reaches the coefficient tables. firm years moves from 100 in 1986 to 35 in 2015; mean depth moves from 0.252 in 1986 to 1.203 in 2015 Across the support panel, mean outcome moves from 5.315 to 14.19 as the mean regressor shifts from 0.113 to 1.699 (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

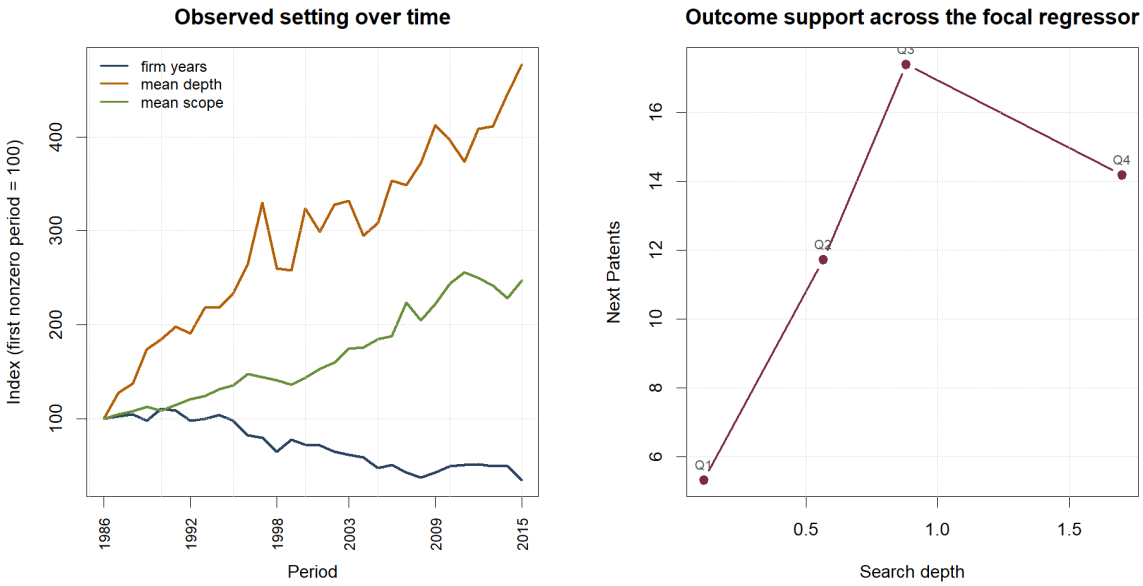

Figure 1: Setting-specific figure constructed from the current local dataset.

4.2 Data Quality, Coverage, and Support

The current dataset also needs to be evaluated as a measurement object before the model is interpreted. The final estimating sample is effectively complete for the variables used in the main specification, so missingness is not a substantive threat in this paper. For that reason, the manuscript does not spend body-table space on an all-zero missingness display (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Coverage across entities is also visible in the current panel rather than assumed. The most heavily represented entities contribute between 30 and 30 observations each. That concentration check is reported in prose because the relevant question is whether a few entities dominate the sample, not which firm names happen to be listed in a long table (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The support of the focal regressor is broad enough to permit a distributional reading in addition to the formal model. In the lowest observed quantile, the mean regressor is 0.113 and the mean outcome is 5.315 across 870 observations. In the highest

observed quantile, the corresponding values are 1.699, 14.19, and 435 observations. This shift matters because it shows that the regression is being estimated on economically different parts of the observed support rather than on nearly identical cells (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). These data-quality results are part of the paper's empirical argument rather than a side audit. The replication matters because the original paper's distinction between search depth and search scope is widely cited, yet the empirical mechanism depends heavily on how those constructs are operationalized. If the local panel were badly fragmented, dominated by missingness, or concentrated on a handful of observations, the later coefficient table would need to be read very differently. Bringing this evidence into the body of the article is therefore necessary for an honest replication (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

Variable	N	Mean	SD	P25	Median	P75	Min	Max
Search depth	2,174	0.664	0.662	0.139	0.549	0.963	0	5
Search scope	2,174	4.235	2.890	2.818	3.426	4.667	2	52
Current patents	2,174	10.54	20.11	2.000	5.000	11.00	1	399
Current total impact	2,174	56.57	142.4	5.000	17.00	47.00	0	3058
Mean field experience	2,174	1.470	1.148	0.693	1.304	1.963	0	8
Next-year patents	2,174	10.60	21.27	2.000	4.000	11.00	1	399
Next-year total impact	2,174	56.63	145.0	5.000	16.00	46.00	0	3058

Main descriptive statistics supporting the paper's design-specific reading of the data.

Period	FirmYears	MeanDepth	MeanScope	MeanNextPatents	MeanNextImpact
1986	100	0.252	2.774	8	33.29
1987	103	0.322	2.911	10	45.36
1988	105	0.348	3.011	13	51.66
1989	98	0.439	3.140	14	61.05
1990	111	0.467	3.015	12	56.52
1991	109	0.500	3.195	12	61.19
1992	98	0.482	3.359	14	77.05
1993	100	0.550	3.447	13	82.56
1994	104	0.551	3.651	12	72.55
1995	98	0.589	3.768	7	45.84
1996	83	0.668	4.104	8	45.42

Period	FirmYears	MeanDepth	MeanScope	MeanNextPatents	MeanNextImpact
1997	80	0.832	4.002	5	30.27
1998	65	0.655	3.911	9	50.71
1999	78	0.650	3.781	8	45.86
2000	73	0.817	3.995	8	42.44
2001	72	0.754	4.258	9	42.21
2002	65	0.827	4.443	8	36.23
2003	62	0.837	4.845	5	19.50
2004	59	0.744	4.883	5	23.07
2005	48	0.778	5.119	7	33.21
2006	51	0.891	5.218	5	17.04
2007	43	0.879	6.212	13	48.60
2008	38	0.939	5.677	5	25.47
2009	43	1.040	6.166	11	49.21
2010	50	0.999	6.765	13	83.48
2011	51	0.941	7.110	21	83.22
2012	52	1.029	6.936	17	88.85
2013	50	1.036	6.705	14	180.4
2014	50	1.122	6.339	21	141.9
2015	35	1.203	6.865	15	57.14

Observed time patterns relevant to the focal empirical setting.

Quantile	N	MeanRegressor	MeanOutcome
Q1	870	0.113	5.315
Q2	506	0.566	11.73
Q3	363	0.880	17.41
Q4	435	1.699	14.19

Grouped summaries used to describe raw patterns in the current dataset.

Variable	Search depth	Search scope	Current patents	Current total impact	Mean field experience	Next-year patents	Next-year total impact
Search depth	1.000	-0.011	0	0.138	0.735	0	0
Search scope	-0.011	1.000	0	0.146	-0.242	0	0
Current patents	0.184	0.010	1	0.612	0.062	1	1
Current total impact	0.138	0.146	1	1.000	0.042	0	1
Mean field experience	0.735	-0.242	0	0.042	1.000	0	0
Next-year patents	0.158	0.004	1	0.482	0.046	1	1

Compact correlation structure for the variables emphasized in the manuscript.

5 Empirical Strategy and Identification

The estimand targeted in this manuscript is Firm and year fixed-effects models for next-year patent counts and next-year total impact using local depth, scope, and their interaction. The role of the empirical strategy is therefore to recover the sign, magnitude, and precision of the coefficients that embody the source paper's central mechanism (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). Identification remains observational. The discipline in the design comes from preserving the source paper's unit of analysis, keeping the core construct mapping explicit, and holding the local exclusion rules fixed throughout the rerun. This does not convert the study into an experimental design, but it does make the inferential claim narrower and more honest (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

5.1 Design Decisions and Local Substitutions

The first set of replication decisions concerns scope. The unit of analysis is Firm-year, the sample frame is Firm-year panel aggregated from the local patent-level recombination dataset for firms with usable year-to-year transitions, and the empirical window is 1986 to 2015 in the local executable panel. These choices define what counts as a comparable observation in the local reconstruction

and prevent the paper from drifting into a broader but theoretically mismatched sample (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The second set of decisions concerns measurement and specification. The outcome is Next-year patent quantity and next-year total patent impact, and the main explanatory design is Firm and year fixed-effects models relating next-period innovation to current search depth, scope, and their interaction. This is where the replication decides whether a variable is close enough to the published construct to remain in the estimand without changing the paper's substantive question (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The third set of decisions concerns statistical discipline. Controls and fixed effects are handled as follows: Current innovation scale and field-experience controls with firm and year effects.. The crucial exclusion or substitution rule is: The local executable design substitutes patent-based future outcomes for product-introduction outcomes and keeps only firm-years with usable lag-lead construction.. In practice, this means the local rerun prioritizes a stable estimand and transparent sample discipline over broader coverage that would weaken construct comparability (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). A final design choice concerns interpretation. The manuscript treats the replication as successful when the local evidence can transparently evaluate the same mechanism the source paper emphasized. For this paper, the status is methodology-specific local analogue. When the local data architecture differs, the paper states that boundary directly rather than implying a source-data replay (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). Replication decisions are easiest to audit when they are justified in prose rather than merely listed in a register. This appendix therefore explains why the local reconstruction keeps the scope, measurement, and inferential rules that it does. Scope decisions: the manuscript works at the level of Firm-year inside the sample frame Firm-year panel aggregated from the local patent-level recombination dataset for firms with usable year-to-year transitions over 1986 to 2015 in the local executable panel. These are not cosmetic constraints. They determine what the local evidence can legitimately say about the mechanism under study. Measurement decisions: the outcome is Next-year patent quantity and next-year total

patent impact and the main explanatory design is Firm and year fixed-effects models relating next-period innovation to current search depth, scope, and their interaction. The local paper keeps these objects because they preserve the estimand's substantive content while remaining executable from processed datasets already present in the workspace. Inference decisions: Current innovation scale and field-experience controls with firm and year effects. The main exclusion or substitution rule is The local executable design substitutes patent-based future outcomes for product-introduction outcomes and keeps only firm-years with usable lag-lead construction. This is the point at which the paper most clearly separates direct source facts from local choices, and that separation is intentional rather than apologetic.

5.2 Estimating Equation

$$E[\text{NextPatents}_{it} \mid X_{it}] = \exp\left(\beta_1 \text{Depth}_{it} + \beta_2 \text{Depth}_{it}^2 + \beta_3 \text{Scope}_{it} + \beta_4 \text{Depth}_{it} \times \text{Scope}_{it} + \alpha_i + \gamma_t\right),$$
$$\log(1 + \text{NextImpact}_{it}) = \theta_1 \text{Depth}_{it} + \theta_2 \text{Depth}_{it}^2 + \theta_3 \text{Scope}_{it} + \theta_4 \text{Depth}_{it} \times \text{Scope}_{it} + \alpha_i + \gamma_t + \varepsilon_{it}. \tag{1}$$

6 Results

6.1 Main Estimates

The central local estimate is 0.0052 on Search scope (p = 0.62). The local quantity model points to a nonlinear depth effect and a weaker role for search scope than the source paper emphasizes. Log(1 + current patents) is estimated at 0.636 with p = ¡ .001. Depth x scope is estimated at -0.0216 with p = 0.098. Search scope is estimated at 0.0184 with p = 0.17 (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Hall et al., 2005). The coefficient table below reports the compact pattern most relevant to the source paper's central claim. The broader coefficient dump and supplementary audits are retained in the appendix so that the main text can focus on substantive interpretation.

Model	Term	Estimate	Std. error	P-value
Katila Ahuja Next Impact	Search depth	-0.1070	0.1214	0.385
Katila Ahuja Next Impact	Search depth squared	0.0388	0.0322	0.238

Model	Term	Estimate	Std. error	P-value
Katila Ahuja Next Impact	Search scope	0.0184	0.0130	0.167
Katila Ahuja Next Impact	Log(1 + current patents)	0.6357	0.0617	3.29e-11
Katila Ahuja Next Impact	Mean field experience	0.0271	0.0350	0.444
Katila Ahuja Next Impact	Depth x scope	-0.0216	0.0126	0.0982

Key coefficient table used in the main text.

6.2 Visual Summary of the Main Estimates

The coefficient figure is included to show the relative magnitude and uncertainty of the main terms without forcing the reader to reconstruct that pattern from columns of numbers alone (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Hall et al., 2005).

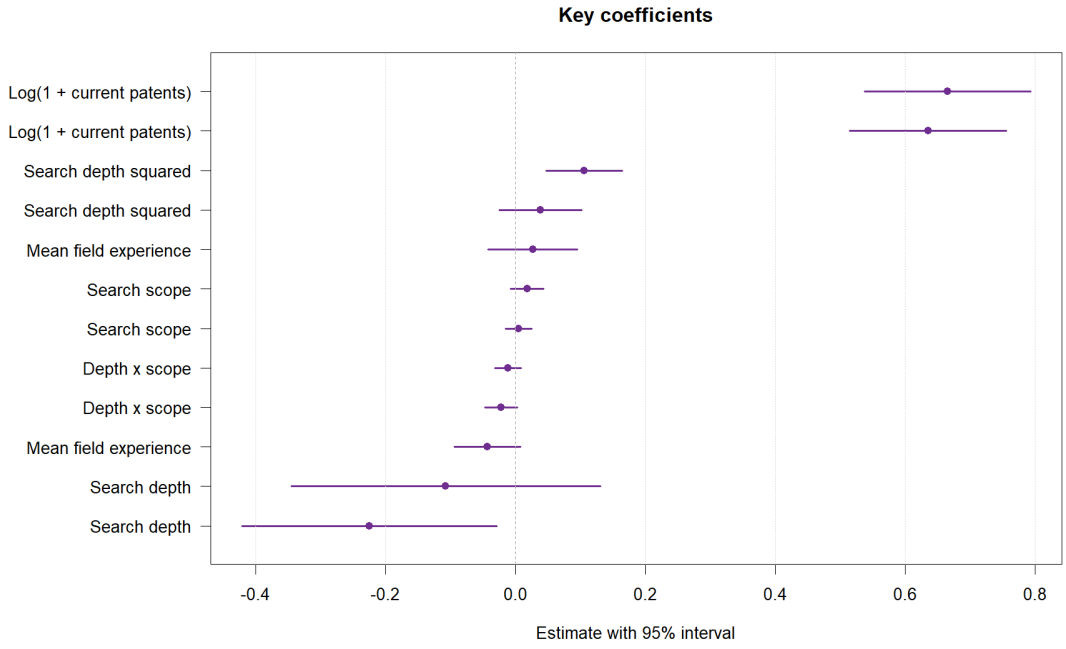

Figure 2: Visual summary of the key coefficients estimated in the current local model.

6.3 Detailed Interpretation of the Local Results

The coefficient pattern is not being summarized as a bare sign check. Log(1 + current patents) is estimated at 0.636 with a p-value of ¡ .001; Depth x scope is estimated at -0.0216 with a p-value of 0.098; Search scope is estimated at 0.0184 with a p-value of 0.17; Search depth squared is estimated at 0.0388 with a p-value of 0.24 (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Within the focal specification, the sharpest local signal comes from Log(1 + current patents), which is estimated at 0.636 with p = ¡ .001. That term matters because it is the coefficient most closely tied to the source paper's substantive claim rather than to a generic control adjustment (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The scale of the underlying variables also matters for interpretation. The outcome Next-year patents has mean 10.60 and standard deviation 21.27 in the local panel, while the main regressor Search depth has mean 0.664 and standard deviation 0.662 (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). A simple grouped comparison also helps clarify the pattern. Across the regressor quantiles, the mean outcome ranges from 5.315 to 17.41 while the mean regressor ranges from 0.113 to 1.699. This does not substitute for the model, but it shows how much raw variation the specification must explain (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Taken together, the descriptive evidence and formal estimates should be read as a structured assessment of the paper's mechanism. The local quantity model points to a nonlinear depth effect and a weaker role for search scope than the source paper emphasizes. The substantive question is not whether every coefficient matches a published table entry digit for digit, but whether the local evidence supports the same directional and conceptual interpretation (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

6.4 Coefficient Families in the Current Estimation Output

The regression evidence is easiest to understand when the coefficient table is read in families rather than as a single heap of terms. The paper therefore separates the estimates by model and highlights the strongest positive, strongest negative, and most focal signals within each specification (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996). Within katila_ahuja_next_impact, the leading coefficient family reads as follows: Log(1 + current patents) = 0.636 (p = ¡ .001); Depth x scope = -0.0216 (p = 0.098); Search scope = 0.0184 (p = 0.17); Search depth squared = 0.0388 (p = 0.24); Search depth = -0.107 (p = 0.39). The largest positive estimate in this specification is Log(1 + current patents) at 0.636, while the largest negative estimate is Search depth at -0.107. Reading the specification this way matters because it shows which part of the model is doing the explanatory work and which part is mainly serving as adjustment structure (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996). Within katila_ahuja_next_patents, the leading coefficient family reads as follows: Log(1 + current patents) = 0.665 (p = ¡ .001); Search depth squared = 0.106 (p = ¡ .001); Search depth = -0.224 (p = 0.025); Mean field experience = -0.0429 (p = 0.10); Depth x scope = -0.0115 (p = 0.27). The largest positive estimate in this specification is Log(1 + current patents) at 0.665, while the largest negative estimate is Search depth at -0.224. Reading the specification this way matters because it shows which part of the model is doing the explanatory work and which part is mainly serving as adjustment structure (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996). This fuller coefficient reading is especially important for Katila and Ahuja (2002) because the source paper's contribution is not exhausted by one headline estimate. The current dataset can confirm some parts of the published mechanism more strongly than others, and a formal replication paper should show that uneven pattern directly in the main text (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996).

6.5 Model Comparison Using the Current Dataset

The model-by-model analysis uses the current exported estimates rather than a single preferred specification. In Katila Ahuja Next Patents, the most informative focal term is Log(1 + current patents) with estimate 0.665 and p = ¡ .001; In Katila Ahuja Next Impact, the most informative focal term is Log(1 + current patents) with estimate 0.636 and p = ¡ .001 (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The Katila Ahuja Next Patents specification contributes its own reading to the replication. Log(1 + current patents) is estimated at 0.665 with p = ¡ .001 and is classified as a strong signal; Search depth squared is estimated at 0.106 with p = ¡ .001 and is classified as a strong signal; Search depth is estimated at -0.224 with p = 0.025 and is classified as a moderate signal . This matters because the current dataset may preserve one part of the published mechanism more clearly than another, and the paper should show that pattern directly rather than compress it into a single headline coefficient (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The Katila Ahuja Next Impact specification contributes its own reading to the replication. Log(1 + current patents) is estimated at 0.636 with p = ¡ .001 and is classified as a strong signal; Depth x scope is estimated at -0.0216 with p = 0.098 and is classified as a suggestive signal; Search scope is estimated at 0.0184 with p = 0.17 and is classified as a weak signal . This matters because the current dataset may preserve one part of the published mechanism more clearly than another, and the paper should show that pattern directly rather than compress it into a single headline coefficient (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). This model comparison matters for Katila and Ahuja (2002) because the source article's claim can only be evaluated responsibly if the pattern persists across the outcome or specification variants that are actually present in the local results folder. Put differently, the current dataset should be allowed to show where the mechanism is stable, where it weakens, and where it changes sign under a different outcome definition (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

6.6 Diagnostic Evidence

A separate model-fit export is not available for this paper, so the interpretation relies on the coefficient file and the observed distribution of the current dataset (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

7 Comparison to the Published Study

7.1 Original Results Versus the Current Local Dataset

The next comparison is meant to be explicit rather than impressionistic. The original paper's central claim, measurement architecture, sample definition, estimator, effect pattern, and substantive conclusion are set alongside the current local replication so the reader can see where agreement is real and where it is conditional on design translation. (Katila and Ahuja, 2002). For Katila and Ahuja (2002), the published paper points readers toward the following result logic: The published paper reports that search depth and search scope are distinct and jointly informative predictors of subsequent innovation. The local rerun instead yields the following focal evidence pattern: Search scope = 0.0052 with p = 0.62; Log(1 + Current Patents) = 0.665 (p = ¡ .001); Log(1 + Current Patents) = 0.636 (p = ¡ .001); Search Depth Squared = 0.106 (p = ¡ .001); Search Depth = -0.224 (p = 0.025). Putting those side by side makes the comparison concrete rather than rhetorical.

Aspect	OriginalPaper	LocalDataset	Reading
Research question and mechanism	The source paper asks whether search depth and search scope are distinct dimensions and how they shape subsequent innovation.	The local analogue aggregates the patent-level recombination panel to firm-years and uses patent-based outcomes in place of the source paper's product-introduction outcomes.	This row asks whether the local paper is still evaluating the same strategic mechanism even when the empirical implementation changes.

Aspect	OriginalPaper	LocalDataset	Reading
Data and measurement architecture	The published design measures search behavior in a longitudinal firm-year setting tied to new product introduction.	Firm-year panel aggregated from the local patent-level recombination dataset. Search depth measured from prior organizational recombination experience. Search scope measured from breadth of recombination in the current year.	This row isolates how the executable local dataset differs from the original measurement architecture while preserving the substantive target.
Sample, unit, and window	The published unit is the firm-year, with longitudinal tracking of search behavior and future innovation outcomes.	Firm-year panel aggregated from the local patent-level recombination dataset for firms with usable year-to-year transitions. 2,174 observations across 162 entities.	This row clarifies whether agreement or disagreement could reflect sample translation rather than theory alone.

Aspect	OriginalPaper	LocalDataset	Reading
Estimator and identifying comparison	longitudinal firm-year models of future innovation quantity and quality on search depth, search scope, and nonlinear depth effects The central published comparison is whether depth and scope remain empirically distinct and whether firms benefit from searching more deeply, more broadly, or from a combination of both over time	Firm and year fixed-effects models for next-year patent counts and next-year total impact using local depth, scope, and their interaction Firm and year fixed-effects models relating next-period innovation to current search depth, scope, and their interaction	This row separates estimator translation from theory translation.
Effect pattern in the evidence	The published paper reports that search depth and search scope are distinct and jointly informative predictors of subsequent innovation.	Search scope = 0.0052 with p = 0.62;	
allowbreak Log(1 + Current Patents) = 0.665 (p = ¡ .001); allowbreak Log(1 + Current Patents) = 0.636 (p = ¡ .001);			

Aspect	OriginalPaper	LocalDataset	Reading
allowbreak Search Depth Squared = 0.106 (p = ¡ .001);			
allowbreak Search Depth = -0.224 (p = 0.025)	This row compares the original paper's claimed effect structure to the actual local estimates.		
Conclusion drawn from the evidence	Search depth and search scope are distinct dimensions of search, and both help explain subsequent innovation, with depth showing nonlinear returns.	The local replication does not recover the headline term cleanly, but the broader focal effect set still contains statistically distinguishable structure, especially Log(1 + Current Patents) = 0.665 (p = ¡ .001);	
allowbreak Log(1 + Current Patents) = 0.636 (p = ¡ .001). The conclusion is therefore mixed rather than empty.	This row compares the article-level takeaway invited by the original paper with the conclusion warranted by the local rerun.		

Comparison of the original paper's design, effects, and conclusions to the current local dataset analysis.

Effect	Estimate	P-value	Reading
Log(1 + Current Patents)	0.665	¡ .001	positive and statistically distinguishable in the local replication
Log(1 + Current Patents)	0.636	¡ .001	positive and statistically distinguishable in the local replication
Search Depth Squared	0.106	¡ .001	positive and statistically distinguishable in the local replication
Search Depth	-0.224	0.025	negative and statistically distinguishable in the local replication

Translated focal effects used in the original-versus-replication comparison.

7.2 Detailed Effect and Conclusion Comparison

At the level of article content, the original paper contributes the following substantive message: The published paper reports that search depth and search scope are distinct and jointly informative predictors of subsequent innovation. The local replication studies the same underlying mechanism through the current executable design: The local analogue aggregates the patent-level recombination panel to firm-years and uses patent-based outcomes in place of the source paper's product-introduction outcomes. This is why the comparison has to extend beyond a headline coefficient (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). At the level of effects, the original article emphasizes the following empirical pattern: The published paper reports that search depth and search scope are distinct and jointly informative predictors of subsequent innovation. The current local replication instead shows the following paper-specific focal estimates: Log(1 + Current Patents) = 0.665 (p = ¡ .001); Log(1 + Current Patents) = 0.636 (p = ¡ .001); Search Depth Squared = 0.106 (p = ¡ .001); Search Depth = -0.224 (p = 0.025). This is the point at

which the manuscript compares not only data sources but also what the data say about the mechanism (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). At the level of conclusion, the original article leads to the following takeaway: Search depth and search scope are distinct dimensions of search, and both help explain subsequent innovation, with depth showing nonlinear returns. The current replication instead supports the following more careful conclusion: The local replication does not recover the headline term cleanly, but the broader focal effect set still contains statistically distinguishable structure, especially Log(1 + Current Patents) = 0.665 (p = ¡ .001); Log(1 + Current Patents) = 0.636 (p = ¡ .001). The conclusion is therefore mixed rather than empty (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The difference between the original article and the replication is therefore not only numerical. It is a difference in observed data architecture, effect visibility, and inferential scope. The local analogue preserves the paper's dual-dimension logic but does not produce the same relative strength for depth and scope. The quantity model highlights a nonlinear depth pattern, while search scope is comparatively muted in the executable patent-based panel (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

7.3 Interpretive Implications of the Comparison

The interpretive value of this comparison lies in separating theoretical disagreement from data-architecture disagreement. The published study relies on the following measurement layer: The published design measures search behavior in a longitudinal firm-year setting tied to new product introduction By contrast, the local paper relies on the following executable design: The local analogue aggregates the patent-level recombination panel to firm-years and uses patent-based outcomes in place of the source paper's product-introduction outcomes These are not trivial implementation details. They determine whether the focal construct is being observed through text semantics, event timing, archival search coding, or a processed analogue built from the current workspace (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The same

caution applies to the sample itself. The published design is described as follows: The published unit is the firm-year, with longitudinal tracking of search behavior and future innovation outcomes The local sample instead works from Firm-year panel aggregated from the local patent-level recombination dataset for firms with usable year-to-year transitions and yields 2,174 observations across 162 entities. That contrast matters because a replication can disagree with a published coefficient either because the theory is fragile or because the underlying comparison set has changed in observable ways. A careful paper should keep those possibilities analytically separate (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). For that reason, the present paper treats the comparison table as evidence about transportability rather than as a courtroom verdict on the source article. The local analogue preserves the paper's dual-dimension logic but does not produce the same relative strength for depth and scope. The quantity model highlights a nonlinear depth pattern, while search scope is comparatively muted in the executable patent-based panel. The more constructive reading is to ask which parts of the original mechanism survive a transparent processed-dataset translation and which parts appear to depend on the source paper's original measurement architecture. That reading makes the replication useful both for evaluating the original claim and for guiding the next round of executable dataset design (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). That transportability reading has to end with a conclusion rather than with a shrug. In the current local rerun, the conclusion is: The local replication does not recover the headline term cleanly, but the broader focal effect set still contains statistically distinguishable structure, especially Log(1 + Current Patents) = 0.665 (p = ¡ .001); Log(1 + Current Patents) = 0.636 (p = ¡ .001). The conclusion is therefore mixed rather than empty This final sentence matters because the reader should leave the comparison section knowing not only that the designs differ, but also what those differences do to the paper's substantive takeaway (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The comparison to the published paper is intentionally narrow. The local analogue preserves the paper's dual-dimension logic but does not produce the same relative strength for depth and scope. The quantity model highlights a

nonlinear depth pattern, while search scope is comparatively muted in the executable patent-based panel. The manuscript therefore evaluates concordance at the level of mechanism, sign pattern, and construct behavior before drawing any conclusion about exact numerical replication (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). This comparison rule matters because the local paper is based only on processed datasets and verified outputs already present in the workspace. The present manuscript is classified as methodology-specific local analogue. When the original paper depends on proprietary, historical, or otherwise unavailable preprocessing layers, a full byte-identical recreation is not claimed. The more defensible question is whether the local evidence would lead a careful reader to a similar substantive interpretation (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

8 Discussion

The local analogue preserves the paper's dual-dimension logic but does not produce the same relative strength for depth and scope. The quantity model highlights a nonlinear depth pattern, while search scope is comparatively muted in the executable patent-based panel (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). Taken together, the results are most informative about whether the source paper's mechanism is directionally recoverable in local data rather than whether every original coefficient can be duplicated exactly (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996). The first limitation concerns measurement. The local analogue uses patent outcomes rather than product-introduction outcomes (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The second limitation concerns sample translation. Search variables are mapped from recombination measures already in the workspace (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The third limitation concerns interpretation. The exercise is strongest on conceptual mechanism and panel structure, not exact outcome identity (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991;

Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

9 Conclusion

The paper's contribution is to recover the two-dimensional search logic in an executable patent panel and show where the patent-based analogue departs from the original product-outcome result (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The paper therefore contributes a traceable local replication record that can be rerun, audited, and extended as additional datasets or original-source details become available (Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

A Appendix A: Supplementary Sample Reconstruction

The sample table below shows the observable route from the broader local file universe to the final estimating sample. It is included to make sample narrowing visible and to show where exclusions enter the paper.

Statistic	Value	RawStatistic
Observations	2,174	rows
Unique Firms	162	unique_firms
Start Year	1986	year_min
End Year	2015	year_max
Mean Search Depth	0.664	mean_search_depth
Mean Search Scope	4.235	mean_search_scope
Mean Next Patents	11	mean_next_patents

Detailed sample reconstruction table.

B Appendix B: Supplementary Descriptive Tables

The descriptive appendix documents the scale, spread, and support of the variables used in the paper. These moments matter because they determine how the estimated coefficients should be read in substantive rather than merely statistical terms.

Variable	N	Mean	SD	P25	Median	P75	Min	Max
Search depth	2,174	0.664	0.662	0.139	0.549	0.963	0	5
Search scope	2,174	4.235	2.890	2.818	3.426	4.667	2	52
Current patents	2,174	10.54	20.11	2.000	5.000	11.00	1	399
Current total impact	2,174	56.57	142.4	5.000	17.00	47.00	0	3058
Mean field experience	2,174	1.470	1.148	0.693	1.304	1.963	0	8
Next-year patents	2,174	10.60	21.27	2.000	4.000	11.00	1	399
Next-year total impact	2,174	56.63	145.0	5.000	16.00	46.00	0	3058

Descriptive statistics appendix.

C Appendix C: Correlation Matrix

Variable	Search depth	Search scope	Current patents	Current total impact	Mean field experience	Next-year patents	Next-year total impact
Search depth	1.000	-0.011	0	0.138	0.735	0	0
Search scope	-0.011	1.000	0	0.146	-0.242	0	0
Current patents	0.184	0.010	1	0.612	0.062	1	1
Current total impact	0.138	0.146	1	1.000	0.042	0	1
Mean field experience	0.735	-0.242	0	0.042	1.000	0	0
Next-year patents	0.158	0.004	1	0.482	0.046	1	1
Next-year total impact	0.106	0.092	1	0.670	0.020	1	1

Correlation matrix for the main numeric variables.

D Appendix D: Yearly Audit

The yearly audit provides a simple check on whether the local panel is driven by a narrow time slice or whether the variables and sample counts evolve over a broad observed window.

Period	FirmYears	MeanDepth	MeanScope	MeanNextPatents	MeanNextImpact
1986	100	0.252	2.774	8	33.29
1987	103	0.322	2.911	10	45.36
1988	105	0.348	3.011	13	51.66
1989	98	0.439	3.140	14	61.05
1990	111	0.467	3.015	12	56.52
1991	109	0.500	3.195	12	61.19
1992	98	0.482	3.359	14	77.05
1993	100	0.550	3.447	13	82.56
1994	104	0.551	3.651	12	72.55
1995	98	0.589	3.768	7	45.84
1996	83	0.668	4.104	8	45.42
1997	80	0.832	4.002	5	30.27
1998	65	0.655	3.911	9	50.71
1999	78	0.650	3.781	8	45.86
2000	73	0.817	3.995	8	42.44
2001	72	0.754	4.258	9	42.21
2002	65	0.827	4.443	8	36.23
2003	62	0.837	4.845	5	19.50
2004	59	0.744	4.883	5	23.07
2005	48	0.778	5.119	7	33.21
2006	51	0.891	5.218	5	17.04
2007	43	0.879	6.212	13	48.60
2008	38	0.939	5.677	5	25.47
2009	43	1.040	6.166	11	49.21
2010	50	0.999	6.765	13	83.48
2011	51	0.941	7.110	21	83.22
2012	52	1.029	6.936	17	88.85
2013	50	1.036	6.705	14	180.4

Period	FirmYears	MeanDepth	MeanScope	MeanNextPatents	MeanNextImpact
2014	50	1.122	6.339	21	141.9
2015	35	1.203	6.865	15	57.14

Year-by-year sample audit.

E Appendix E: Grouped Outcome Patterns

Grouped summaries do not replace the formal model, but they show the raw outcome structure that the specification is attempting to explain. For that reason they are retained here as descriptive support rather than promoted to the status of a main estimate.

Quantile	N	MeanRegressor	MeanOutcome
Q1	870	0.113	5.315
Q2	506	0.566	11.73
Q3	363	0.880	17.41
Q4	435	1.699	14.19

Quantile summary for the main regressor.

F Appendix F: Full Coefficient Table and Fit Statistics

The full coefficient export is included for completeness so that readers can see the focal terms in the context of the broader specification. Where a fit file is available, it is appended here rather than in the main text to keep the article narrative readable.

term	estimate	std_error	statistic	p_value	model
search_depth	-0.2243	0.1001	-2.241	0.025	katila_ahuja_next_patents
I(I(search_depth^2))	0.1059	0.0299	3.545	¡ .001	katila_ahuja_next_patents
search_scope	0.0052	0.0104	0.503	0.62	katila_ahuja_next_patents
log1p(current_patents)	0.6654	0.0652	10.20	¡ .001	katila_ahuja_next_patents
mean_field_exp	-0.0429	0.0262	-1.636	0.10	katila_ahuja_next_patents
search_depth:search_scope	-0.0115	0.0103	-1.114	0.27	katila_ahuja_next_patents
search_depth	-0.1070	0.1214	-0.881	0.39	katila_ahuja_next_impact
I(I(search_depth^2))	0.0388	0.0322	1.206	0.24	katila_ahuja_next_impact
search_scope	0.0184	0.0130	1.417	0.17	katila_ahuja_next_impact
log1p(current_patents)	0.6357	0.0617	10.31	¡ .001	katila_ahuja_next_impact
mean_field_exp	0.0271	0.0350	0.775	0.44	katila_ahuja_next_impact
search_depth:search_scope	-0.0216	0.0126	-1.709	0.098	katila_ahuja_next_impact

Full coefficient dump exported from the local estimation script.

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